

Seth Walker

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July 2, 2026

Current Employment

Postdoctoral Scholar , SCALE Initiative Stanford University Graduate School of Education	2026-
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Education

Ph.D.	Economics, Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI	2026
M.A.	Economics, Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI	2022
B.S.	Economics, James Madison University, Harrisonburg, VA, <i>summa cum laude</i> MINOR: MATHEMATICS	2020
B.M.	Music Performance, James Madison University, Harrisonburg, VA, <i>summa cum laude</i>	2020

Research Interests

Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Publications

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- *Financial Aid Package Composition and Postsecondary Outcomes for Low-income Students: Evidence from the Spartan Advantage Program.* *Education Finance and Policy*, 2026. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)
 - *Measuring Teacher Effectiveness for Gifted and Talented Students* - with Scott Imberman and Katharine Strunk. *Economics of Education Review*, 2025. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)
 - *The Path of Student Learning Delay During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Evidence from Michigan* - with Katharine Strunk, Tara Kilbride, Scott Imberman, Dongming Yu, Bryant Hopkins. *Education Finance and Policy*, 2025. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)

Working Papers

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- *Losing Eligibility, Losing Ground? The Consequences of Financial Aid Eligibility Loss Later in College: Evidence from the TEXAS Grant.* [\[PDF\]](#)
 - *Estimating the Overall Effects of Statewide Early Literacy Policies: Evidence from Michigan* - with Josep Nadal-Fernandez and Tara Kilbride. [\[PDF\]](#)
 - *Teaching on Borrowed Time: How the Teacher Loan Forgiveness Program Delays, But Does Not Prevent, Teacher Attrition.* [\[PDF\]](#)

Work in Progress

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- *When Advanced Learning Programs Expand: Evidence on Access and Achievement* - with Tara Kilbride
 - *Financial Aid Loss and Major Switching: Evidence from the TEXAS Grant*
 - *Paying to Stay: How Student Loan Repayment Affects Teacher Retention in Michigan* - with Jason Burns and Tara Kilbride

Technical Reports

- *Retention and Exemption Decisions Under the Read by Grade Three Law* - with Tara Kilbride and Josep Nadal-Fernandez - EPIC Research Report, 2024. [\[Report\]](#)
- *Insight to MSU's Applicant Funnel: An Introduction & Foundation* - with Emilio Esposito and Steven Miller, Office for Enrollment & Strategic Planning Report, 2024. [\[Report\]](#)
- *Read by Grade Three Retention Eligibility: 2023 Update* - with Tara Kilbride, EPIC Research Report, 2023. [\[Report\]](#)

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026: Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (upcoming)

2025: Association for Public Policy and Management; Midwest Economics of Education (Flash Talk); MSU Empirical Micro Seminar; MSU Grand River Conference; UM-MSU-UWO Labor Day; Midwest Economics Association; Association for Education and Finance Policy

2024: Southern Economics Association; MSU Empirical Micro Seminar

2023: MSU Red Cedar Conference

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Education Policy Innovation Collaborative (MSU)	Spring 2023-Summer 2026
Research Assistant, Professor Scott Imberman (MSU)	Spring 2023-Summer 2025
Research Assistant, Professor Steven Miller and Dr. Emilio Esposito (MSU Office of the Provost)	Spring 2022-Summer 2025
Research Assistant, Professor Vipul Bhatt (JMU)	Spring 2018-Spring 2020

Teaching Experience

Instructor

EC 370 - Economics of Sports	Summer 2022
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Teaching Assistant

ISS 328 - The Social Science of Sports	Fall 2022
EC 425 - Law and Economics	Spring 2022
EC 420 - Introduction to Econometric Methods	Fall 2021
EC 301 - Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2021
EC 302 - Intermediate Macroeconomics	Fall 2020

Grants & Awards

Travel Fellowship (MSU)	2025
Research Enhancement Award (MSU)	2024
Red Cedar Award (MSU)	2023
<i>Awarded for best third-year paper among Economics Ph.D. students</i>	
Faculty Award for Academic Excellence in Economics (JMU)	2020
The Phi Beta Kappa Society (JMU)	2019

Service

Referee Service

Education Finance and Policy, Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis

University Service

Enrollment and Academic Strategic Planning Think Tank

2022-2023

Department of Economics First-Year Mentor

2021-2022

Software

R, Stata, L^AT_EX

References

Scott Imberman (Chair)

Professor

Department of Economics

Michigan State University

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Todd Elder

Professor

Department of Economics

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Steven Miller

Professor

Department of Agricultural, Food,
and Resource Economics

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Tara Kilbride

Associate Director

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